

The Meridian Masterplan

From Zero to Funded

Below is a phased curriculum with objective graduation gates. You don't advance because you "feel ready" — you advance because you passed the gate. This is what separates a masterplan from a course list.

PHASE 0 · Week 0

Infrastructure, firm rules, sizing, journal

PHASE 1 · Weeks 1–3

Regime, Liquidity Map, 3-Gate, Lattice

PHASE 2 · Weeks 4–6

CVD, Absorption, Imbalance, Stacked Imbalance

PHASE 3 · Weeks 7–9

Integration, 3 written setups, cadence

PHASE 4 · Weeks 10–14

Backtest → forward → evaluation

PHASE 5 · Ongoing

Funded management, scale ladder

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Infrastructure & Reality Check

Do not skip this. Most prop firm failures are plumbing failures, not signal failures.

0.1 Platform prerequisites

REQUIREMENT	WHY	FALLBACK
TradingView Premium or Ultimate	request.footprint() — native diagonal bid/ask — only works here	Lower plans get the CVD proxy (dashboard tags <code>px</code> instead of <code>FP</code>). Coarser, not diagonal.
Futures data feed (CME real-time)	ES/NQ/YM/GC need live exchange data	Delayed data ruins the Silver Bullet window timing
Companion backtest strategy script	The engine is an indicator, not a strategy. No fills, no equity curve.	You must measure win rate / PF / DD yourself

0.2 Pick your prop firm BEFORE you build the plan

The firm's rules become hard constraints in your position-sizing math — not afterthoughts.

Extract these numbers and write them on a card:

- Daily loss limit (\$ and %)
- Trailing / static max drawdown
- Profit target
- Consistency rule (e.g. "no single day > 50% of total profit")
- Minimum trading days
- News-trading restrictions
- Instrument restrictions (some firms limit contracts on NQ/ES)

0.3 The sizing formula (memorize this)

SIZING FORMULA

$\text{Contracts} = (\text{Daily Loss Limit} \times 0.40) / (\text{Stop in points} \times \$ \text{ per point})$

NQ: \$20/pt ES: \$50/pt YM: \$5/pt GC: \$100/pt

Example: \$1,500 daily loss limit, NQ, structural stop = 12 points

→ $(1500 \times 0.40) / (12 \times 20) = 2$ contracts maximum

ADDED NOTE — MICRO CONTRACTS & ROUNDING

FULL-SIZE	\$ PER POINT	MICRO	\$ PER POINT
NQ	\$20	MNQ	\$2
ES	\$50	MES	\$5
YM	\$5	MYM	\$0.50
GC	\$100	MGC	\$10

Micros are one-tenth the \$/pt of the full-size contract, so the formula allows ten times the contract count. Fractional results always round DOWN. The example works out to $600 \div 240 = 2.5$, which becomes 2 contracts.

You deliberately use 40% of the daily limit, not 100%. This gives you room for a second and third attempt on a bad day without breaching.

0.4 Journal schema (build it now)

Every trade logs these fields — they map 1:1 to the engine's outputs:

JOURNAL SCHEMA

Date | Session (SB/NYDef/LDN/Asia) | Preset (Auto→Scalp/Intraday/Swing/Position)
Regime (TREND/RANGE/TRANSITION) | Bias | Gate1 cleared? | Gate2 arm type (Sweep/VWAP↑/CHoCH) | Gate3 zone
Lattice grade (WATCH/PRIME/ELITE/SINGULAR) | Event types present (1–10)
OFI reads present: CVD / Abs↑↓ / Imb↑↓ / Stk↑↓ → data source ·FP or ·px
Entry | SL | TP1 | TP2 | TP3 | RR planned
Path outcome: CONFIRM / BREAK | R multiple | \$ P&L | Rule breach? (Y/N)

◆ GATE 0 PASSED WHEN

Firm rules documented, sizing formula calculated for your instrument, journal built, footprint data confirmed working (·FP tag visible in the dashboard).

Meridian Engine v2 Mastery

GOAL

Learn the context layer in isolation. No order flow yet. You must be able to read regime and liquidity without the OFI crutch.

1.1 Week 1 — Regime Engine

The engine classifies every bar from three inputs: ATR relative strength, manual ADX(14), EMA ribbon 9/21/50 alignment.

REGIME	WHAT THE ENGINE DOES	YOUR JOB
TREND	Trades only with ribbon + cloud; no-chase blocks stretched entries	Join pullbacks, never chase
RANGE	Fades premium/discount extremes; gets a fade-into-extremes exception to no-chase	Sell premium, buy discount
TRANSITION	Demands a denser lattice before anything fires	Stand down or halve size

DRILL

Bar Replay, 200 bars, ES + NQ. Call the regime out loud on each bar and say why.

GATE 1A

20 consecutive correct regime reads with correct reasoning.

1.2 Week 2 — Liquidity Memory Map

Confirmed sweeps register a pool with price, direction, intensity, and a decaying magnet. Magnet decays bar by bar, strengthens when price revisits and reverses with volume. Cap is 20 pools; high-magnet pools add lattice weight and can become TP3.

DRILL

Mark every sweep. Track which pools get revisited and which decay to nothing. Log: did the opposing pool actually become TP3?

GATE 1B

You can point to the 3 most magnetically significant pools on any chart and justify each.

1.3 Week 3 — 3-Gate Core + Event Lattice (structure only)

The three gates clear in order:

- **Gate 1 — Bias:** regime-aware direction
- **Gate 2 — Armed:** confirmed liquidity sweep OR volume-backed VWAP reclaim OR bullish/bearish CHoCH. Arms expire after a preset number of bars — stale setups auto-drop.
- **Gate 3 — Zone retest:** price taps an untapped FVG/OB while the lattice reads at least your minimum grade

Lattice grading (structure events only, in this phase):

GRADE	EVENT TYPES	ACTION
WATCH	2	Research only — never live size
PRIME	3	Standard size (this is your live minimum)
ELITE	4	Full size
SINGULAR	5+ and a high-magnet pool in range	Maximum size and RR

Also internalize: mutual exclusion — if long and short fire the same bar, the engine keeps the higher-density side or stands aside on a tie. You will do the same.

◆ GATE 1C

In Bar Replay, pre-write the trade (direction, entry, SL, TP1–3) before the BUY/SELL label prints. Hit 15/20 correct gate sequences.

✓ PHASE 1 COMPLETE WHEN

You can narrate a chart cold — regime → pools → arm → zone → grade — without the OFI layer.

Meridian OFI Stacked Imbalance Mastery

GOAL

Layer order flow on top of the context you already own. Critically — no new gates. OFI events raise density, which raises grade.

2.1 Week 4 — CVD (the primitive)

Volume split by close vs. prior close, accumulated. 3-bar slope sets rising/falling state. Session high/low tracked live. Reset: None / Session / Daily.

DRILL

On 100 bars, mark accumulation vs. distribution phases. Note how often CVD slope flip precedes or lags the regime change.

2.2 Week 5 — Absorption (Type 8) & Imbalance (Type 9)

EVENT	TRIGGER	VISUAL	MEANING
Absorption ↑/↓	Strong opposing delta + rejection at FVG/OB, magnet, or VWAP band	Small green/red circle	Demand absorbing supply / supply absorbing demand
Imbalance ↑/↓	Strong directional delta + CVD agreement + BOS/CHoCH/VWAP reclaim/zone tap	Small cyan/magenta diamond	Conviction continuation, not just a level reaction

DRILL

Classify every Abs and Imb on 100 bars. Which ones had a level behind them? Those are the ones that matter.

2.3 Week 6 — Stacked Imbalance (Type 10) — the differentiator

This is the whole reason to buy the OFI edition.

How it works:

- `request.footprint(fpTicks, 70, fpImbPct)` reads true bid/ask at every price row
- A buy imbalance flags when a row's buy volume $\geq$ threshold% of the sell volume of the row below it → diagonal, 3:1 default
- A sell imbalance mirrors it above
- ≥ 3 consecutive same-side rows = a stacked zone → pushed as lattice type 10
- Optionally registers as a high-intensity magnet (intensity = stack length $\times$ volume ratio)
- Aligned stacks earn a +1 grade nudge

Why diagonal, not same-row: best bid and best ask sit one tick apart. Comparing same-row mixes both sides of the spread and is dominated by microstructure noise. Diagonal isolates genuine initiative.

Tuning table (from the docs):

INSTRUMENT	TICKS/ROW	TARGET ROWS/BAR
ES / NQ	4-20	15-40
Crypto / large-range bars	50-200	15-40

If stacks fire too often, raise Imbalance threshold % from 300 → 400-500%.

◆ **GATE 2A**

20 consecutive correct •FP (native) stack reads. You must distinguish them from •px (proxy) fallback reads and know the difference in reliability.

◆ **GATE 2B**

Explain in writing why a stack that aligns with the lattice is stronger than a stack in isolation.

✓ **PHASE 2 COMPLETE WHEN**

You can identify a stacked imbalance, state whether it's •FP or •px, and say whether it lands on a level you already care about.

Integration & Playbook Construction

Now fuse the layers. You are building a written, repeatable playbook — not vibes.

3.1 Preset mapping

Start on Preset = Auto (derives Scalp / Intraday / Swing / Position from your chart timeframe). Once you have 30+ logged trades, you can justify a manual preset. Not before.

3.2 Write 3 core setups

Each setup must be fully specified:

SETUP TEMPLATE

SETUP NAME: _____
 Instrument(s): _____
 Session window: _____
 Preset: _____
 Regime required: _____

 GATE 1 (Bias): _____
 GATE 2 (Arm – circle one): Sweep / VWAP reclaim / CHoCH
 GATE 3 (Zone): _____

 MINIMUM lattice grade: PRIME / ELITE / SINGULAR
 Required OFI confluence (optional but graded):
 ☐ CVD slope aligned
 ☐ Abs at level
 ☐ Imb with structure
 ☐ Stk↑/↓ ·FP (strongest) OR Stk↑/↓ ·px (weaker – note it)

 Entry: bar close on signal
 SL: structural (beyond sweep or zone invalidation) = ____ pts
 TP1: VWAP or nearest sigma band = ____ pts
 TP2: risk × RR = ____ pts
 TP3: opposing magnet or 1.5 × TP2 = ____ pts

 Contracts (from formula): ____
 Invalidation / no-trade conditions: _____

Suggested three: (A) Trend pullback with Imb + stack, (B) Range fade at premium/discount with Abs, (C) Silver Bullet sweep reversal with stack.

3.3 Session amplification rules

Sessions are amplifiers (×1.25 density), never AND-gates. You never wait for a window — you score higher inside one.

WINDOW	ET	USE
Asia	20:00–00:00	Asia range break, post-close
London	02:00–05:00	Sets the reference high/low for Silver Bullet
Silver Bullet	08:00–09:00	Sweep of prior London H/L — cleanest reversal read
NY Killzone / NYDef	09:30–12:00	Volume-spike test of prior NY extreme with trend alignment

Practical filter: For prop evaluations, restrict live trading to 08:00–12:00 ET. Outside that, journal only.

3.4 The daily operating cadence

TIME (ET)	ACTION
Pre-market	Note Asia range, London H/L, key pools, expected regime
08:00–09:00	Silver Bullet window — highest priority setups
09:30–11:00	NY Killzone — NYDef setups
11:00–12:00	Manage open paths only. No new risk after 11:30.
Post-session	Log every trade in the journal schema. Score your rule adherence 1–10.

◆ GATE 3

You have 3 written setups, you've executed each in Bar Replay 20+ times, and your journal shows you can fill every field without thinking.

Backtest → Forward Test → Evaluation

4.1 Backtest (Weeks 10–11)

Use the companion strategy script. Run across at least 3 instruments × 2 timeframes.

Sample size: 100 trades minimum per configuration. Less than that is noise.

METRIC	MINIMUM TO PROCEED
Profit Factor	≥ 1.3
Max Drawdown	$\leq 60\%$ of the firm's trailing DD
Win rate	Whatever it is — but RR must compensate
Losing streak (max)	Must be survivable under your 40%-of-daily-limit sizing

If low-timeframe noise inflates grades: raise minimum grade to **ELITE**, or widen FVG filters.

◆ GATE 4A

100-trade backtest, PF ≥ 1.3 , max DD inside prop limits, max losing streak survivable.

4.2 Forward test on sim (Weeks 12–13)

20 trades, real-time, sim account, no exceptions. Backtests flatter you; live bar-close timing does not.

Track the Path Integrity stats specifically:

- % of signals that hit PATH CONFIRM (TP1 touched first)
- % that hit PATH BREAK (close beyond stop before TP1)
- If BREAK rate > 45%, your entries are too late or your stops too tight.

◆ GATE 4B

20 forward trades with forward-test PF within 25% of backtest PF. Divergence beyond that means curve-fitting.

4.3 Evaluation (Week 14)

Non-negotiable evaluation rules:

RULE	SETTING
Minimum grade	PRIME (never WATCH live)
Max contracts	From the 40% formula
Max trades/day	3
Stop trading for the day	After 2 consecutive losses or -1.5%
Sessions traded	08:00-12:00 ET only
Instrument	One. Do not switch.

Consistency rule handling: If your firm requires "no day > 50% of total profit," your daily profit cap must be $\approx$ 50% of the target. Example: \$6,000 target → stop the day at \$3,000.

◆ GATE 4C

Evaluation passed.

Funded Account Management

Passing is the easy part. The failure mode is doubling size after funding.

5.1 The first 10 funded days

- Trade the same contract count you used in the evaluation
- No new setups
- Same sessions, same minimum grade
- Re-log everything

5.2 Scale-up ladder

MILESTONE	ACTION
10 funded days, no rule breach	+25% size
30 funded days, no breach, $PF \geq 1.3$	+25% size
Any rule breach	Reset to evaluation size for 10 days
Payout taken	Reset to evaluation size for 5 days

Size increases only ever follow rule adherence — never follow a winning streak.

Failure Modes & Kill Switches

FAILURE MODE	KILL SWITCH
Revenge trading after a BREAK	Hard stop after 2 losses. Close the platform.
Trading TRANSITION regime "just this once"	Engine demands denser lattice — so do you. No exceptions.
Chasing entries in TREND	No-chase blocks stretched entries. If the label didn't print, there's no trade.
Overtrading low-grade setups	Min grade PRIME . Lock it in settings.
Trading  proxy stacks as if they're 	Tag every read in the journal. Discount proxy reads by one grade mentally.
Ignoring the consistency rule	Daily profit cap = 50% of target. Automate the stop.
Switching instruments mid-evaluation	One instrument. One playbook.
Conflicting signals	Engine's mutual exclusion already handles it — take the higher-density side or stand aside.

Mastery Timeline Summary

PHASE	WEEKS	FOCUS	GRADUATION GATE
0	0	Infrastructure, firm rules, sizing, journal	Rules documented, •FP confirmed
1	1–3	Regime, Liquidity Map, 3-Gate, Lattice	15/20 gate sequences pre-called
2	4–6	CVD, Absorption, Imbalance, Stacked Imbalance	20/20 stack reads, •FP vs •px
3	7–9	Integration, 3 written setups, cadence	Setups written + replayed 20× each
4	10–14	Backtest → forward → evaluation	PF ≥ 1.3, eval passed
5	Ongoing	Funded management, scale ladder	Adherence-based sizing only

The One-Paragraph Version

Weeks 1–3: Meridian Engine v2 Mastery — learn regime, liquidity magnets, and the 3-gate sequence until you can narrate a chart without the OFI layer. **Weeks 4–6:** Meridian OFI Stacked Imbalance — add CVD, absorption, imbalance, and the native diagonal footprint stack (type 10), the strongest initiative signal in the system. **Weeks 7–9:** write three setups and a daily cadence. **Weeks 10–14:** 100-trade backtest ($PF \geq 1.3$), 20-trade forward test, then evaluation at **PRIME** minimum grade, one instrument, 08:00–12:00 ET, 40%-of-daily-limit sizing. Then manage the funded account with an adherence-based scale ladder — never a streak-based one.

The engine gives you regime, grade, and a tracked path from entry to TP3. It does not give you discipline. That's the part you're actually building.

Toolkit Quick Reference

Static version of the interactive calculator and gate tracker in the HTML edition.

T1 Sizing & Prop Rules Worksheet

\$ PER POINT							
NQ \$20	ES \$50	YM \$5	GC \$100	MNQ \$2	MES \$5	MYM \$0.50	MGC \$10

OUTPUT	FORMULA	YOUR VALUE
Max contracts	$\text{ROUNDDOWN}((\text{Daily loss limit} \times 40\%) \div (\text{Stop pts} \times \$/\text{pt}))$	
\$ risk per trade	$\text{Contracts} \times \text{Stop pts} \times \$/\text{pt}$	
Full-risk losses before the daily limit	$\text{ROUNDDOWN}(\text{Daily loss limit} \div \$ \text{ risk per trade})$	
Daily profit cap	$\text{Consistency \%} \times \text{Profit target}$	
Backtest max-DD ceiling	$60\% \times \text{Trailing drawdown}$	

Worked example from the plan: \$1,500 daily loss limit, NQ, 12-pt stop → $(1500 \times 0.40) \div (12 \times 20) = 2.5 \rightarrow 2$ contracts. \$6,000 target at a 50% consistency rule → \$3,000 daily cap.

T2 Gate Checklist

GATE	PHASE	PASS CRITERION	TARGET(S)	PASSED	DATE
0	0	Firm rules documented, sizing formula calculated for your instrument, journal built, footprint data confirmed working (•FP tag visible in the dashboard).	☐ Firm rules documented ☐ Sizing formula calculated for your instrument ☐ Journal built ☐ •FP tag visible in the dashboard	☐	
1a	1	20 consecutive correct regime reads with correct reasoning.	Consecutive correct regime reads ≥ 20	☐	
1b	1	You can point to the 3 most magnetically significant pools on any chart and justify each.	Top pools identified and justified ≥ 3	☐	
1c	1	In Bar Replay, pre-write the trade (direction, entry, SL, TP1–3) before the BUY/SELL label prints. Hit 15/20 correct gate sequences.	Correct gate sequences (out of 20) ≥ 15	☐	
2a	2	20 consecutive correct •FP (native) stack reads. You must distinguish them from •px (proxy) fallback reads and know the difference in reliability.	Consecutive correct •FP stack reads ≥ 20	☐	
2b	2	Explain in writing why a stack that aligns with the lattice is stronger than a stack in isolation.	☐ Written explanation completed	☐	
3	3	You have 3 written setups, you've executed each in Bar Replay 20+ times, and your journal shows you can fill every field without thinking.	Setups written ≥ 3 Setup A — Bar Replay executions ≥ 20 Setup B — Bar Replay executions ≥ 20 Setup C — Bar Replay executions ≥ 20 ☐ Journal: every field filled without thinking	☐	
4a	4	100-trade backtest, PF ≥ 1.3 , max DD inside prop limits, max losing streak survivable.	Backtest trades (per configuration) ≥ 100 Backtest profit factor ≥ 1.3 Backtest max DD $\leq 60\%$ of trailing DD ☐ Max losing streak survivable	☐	

GATE	PHASE	PASS CRITERION	TARGET(S)	PASSED	DATE
4b	4	20 forward trades with forward-test PF within 25% of backtest PF. Divergence beyond that means curve-fitting.	Forward (sim) trades $\geq$ 20 Forward PF within 25% of backtest PF	☐	
4c	4	Evaluation passed.	☐ Evaluation passed	☐	